

COMMUNICATION SKILL - Session 7

FACIAL EXPRESSIONS AND GESTURES

Facial expressions and gestures are important nonverbal cues that can add depth and nuance to communication. They can convey emotions, emphasis, and context that words alone cannot. For example, a smile can make a statement more approachable, while a raised eyebrow can signal skepticism. Facial expressions can also help to emphasize and amplify what is being said, providing a more convincing argument.

How to use gestures and facial expressions effectively

To use gestures and facial expressions effectively, you must make them natural, relevant, and varied. Don't force or overdo your movements; they should match your personality and tone. Practice in front of a mirror or camera to see how you look and feel. Make sure your gestures and facial expressions support your message and purpose. Use different types of gestures to show confidence, enthusiasm, precision, detail, emotion, interest, and empathy. Avoid using the same gestures throughout your speech as they can become monotonous.

How to avoid common mistakes

Gestures and facial expressions can have a powerful impact on your message, but it is important to be aware of the common mistakes to avoid. Crossing your arms or legs can make you appear defensive or disinterested, while touching your face or hair can make you appear nervous or insecure. Pointing your finger or fist can make you seem aggressive, and rolling your eyes or yawning can make you look bored and disrespectful. Looking away or down can also give off the wrong impression, making you seem shy, uncertain, or dishonest.

How to adapt to different situations

When delivering a speech, the gestures and facial expressions you use should be adjusted depending on the context, audience, and goal. Distance is an important factor to consider; the farther away you are from your audience, the larger your gestures and facial expressions need to be. Additionally, cultural norms should be taken into account; certain gestures that are positive in one culture may be negative or offensive in another. It's also beneficial to pay attention to the feedback and reactions of your audience; if they appear confused, bored, or hostile, you may need to adjust your gestures and facial expressions accordingly. On the other hand, if they look interested, amused, or supportive, you may need to maintain or amplify your gestures and facial expressions to reinforce, entertain, or persuade them.

How to practice and improve

Using gestures and facial expressions effectively is a skill that requires practice and improvement. To hone this skill, observe how other speakers use them, particularly those who are good at public speaking. Analyze your own strengths and weaknesses by watching videos of yourself or others. Experiment with different gestures and facial expressions in different situations and ask for feedback from friends, colleagues, or mentors. Lastly, don't be too self-conscious or worried about your gestures and facial expressions; let them reflect your passion and personality. Enjoy the process of mastering them!

Activity 1

- Step 1 Divide the group into 2 teams
- Step 2 Play dumbsharads with topics either from general knowledge or sports or famous personalities. (ex - solar system, NASA, Shri Abdul Kalam or any cricketers etc)
- Step 3 Only actions and gestures to be used and the other team guesses the same.
- Stem 4 The team with maximum guesses wins the game.